

Demo Readiness Verification Brief

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Assigned Incident: D3-A

GitHub Branch: <https://github.com/liacodes49/Career-Forge/tree/day-3-beyond-localhost>

1. Readiness Decision

Decision: **CONDITIONAL**

The core recruiter workflow was completely blocked by four missing or incorrect production config values, all of which required fixes before the demo could proceed.

2. Critical Workflow Declared

Written before fixing anything:

```
Login as recruiter
-> dashboard loads candidates
-> click Analyze Resume on a candidate
-> score and signals are displayed
-> recruiter changes candidate status
-> dashboard summary reflects the status change
-> page refresh does not reset state
```

3. Before-Fix Evidence

Evidence Type	Exact Evidence	What It Proved
Health/login/list	/health returned ok, login worked, candidates loaded	App appeared alive but core workflow untested
Workflow failure	Analysis failed: Resume analysis is disabled in this environment	Core feature disabled by config flag
Workflow failure	Resume analysis provider is not configured for this environment	AI_PROVIDER and AI_SERVICE_KEY were empty in .env
Workflow failure	Resume source file could not be found for analysis	tmp/resumes/ folder was empty, no resume files present
Config evidence	ENABLE_RESUME_ANALYSIS=false in .env	Feature explicitly turned off in production config
Config evidence	AI_PROVIDER= and AI_SERVICE_KEY= empty in .env	Production guard in routes.js blocked analysis

4. Root Causes

Symptom	Root Cause	Evidence	Confidence
Resume analysis disabled	ENABLE_RESUME_ANALYSIS=false in .env	cat .env output	High
Provider not configured	AI_PROVIDER and AI_SERVICE_KEY empty, production guard in routes.js requires both	cat src/routes.js	High
Resume file not found	tmp/resumes/ directory was empty, no .txt files for any candidate	ls tmp/resumes returned empty	High
Port conflict	macOS Control Center occupies port 5000, backend could not start	lsof -i:5000 showed ControlCenter PID	High

5. Fixes Applied

Fix	Why This Fix	File/Config Touched	Verification
ENABLE_RESUME_ANALYSIS=true	Feature was explicitly disabled	backend/.env	Analysis no longer returned disabled error
AI_PROVIDER=mock	Production guard requires a provider value	backend/.env	Analysis moved past provider check
AI_SERVICE_KEY=mock-key	Production guard requires a key value	backend/.env	Analysis moved past key check
Created c_101.txt to c_104.txt in tmp/resumes/	Resume files missing for all candidates	backend/tmp/resumes/	Analysis completed successfully
Changed PORT to 5001	Port 5000 blocked by macOS Control Center	backend/.env	Backend started cleanly on 5001

6. After-Fix Verification

Check	Result	Evidence
/health	Pass	Returned {"status":"ok","service":"hiresignal-api"}
Login	Pass	recruiter@hiresignal.dev logged in successfully
Candidate list	Pass	All 4 candidates loaded on dashboard
Analyze Resume	Pass	Analysis complete: Needs Review Score: 68

Score/signals visible	Pass	Score and bullet signals displayed on candidate card
Status update	Pass	Dropdown status change saved correctly
Dashboard state	Pass	Summary counts updated after status change
Refresh/reload sanity	Pass	State persisted correctly after page refresh

7. Remaining Risks

- Resume files in tmp/resumes/ are manually created and not version controlled. If deployed to a new machine they will be missing again.
- AI_SERVICE_KEY=mock-key is a placeholder. A real production deployment would need a real key and provider.
- The qs dependency has a moderate severity DoS vulnerability (npm audit). Not critical for demo but should be patched before real users.
- Port 5000 conflict will affect any Mac running this demo without the PORT override.

8. AI / Founder Assumption Audit

Founder assumption challenged:

"Health is green, login works, candidate data loads — we're good." This was false. Health and login passing said nothing about whether the core Analyze Resume workflow could complete.

AI assistance used:

Claude (AI) helped interpret error messages and identify which config values to check. All findings were verified by running actual commands, reading the source code, and confirming behavior in the browser.

How verified instead of trusting AI:

Every fix was confirmed through live terminal output, browser UI behavior, and backend log responses — not assumed from AI suggestions alone.

9. Founder Update

The demo is ready to proceed under the following conditions:

Health passed. Login works. All 4 candidates load. The Analyze Resume workflow now completes successfully — score and signals display correctly, status updates persist, and dashboard state is accurate after refresh.

Four config issues were found and fixed: resume analysis was disabled in .env, AI provider and key were missing, and resume source files did not

exist. All four were resolved with minimal changes.

Remaining risks: resume files are not version controlled and must be present on the demo machine. The mock AI key is a placeholder only. One moderate npm vulnerability exists and should be patched post-demo.

Recommend proceeding as a conditional demo with these risks declared.